

Ohio Total Loss and Salvage Title Requirements

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Purpose: Internal reference summarizing Ohio requirements relevant to total-loss vehicle handling.

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This document is a synthetic reference prepared for a software assessment corpus. Figures and procedures are presented for realism and internal consistency with this corpus only and should not be relied on as current legal advice.

1. Salvage Title Trigger

Under Ohio requirements referenced by this corpus, a vehicle must be branded with a salvage title when an insurer pays a total loss claim and the vehicle is not repaired to a roadworthy standard before resale. This applies regardless of whether the insured retains the vehicle or transfers it to the insurer.

2. Insurer Obligations on a Total Loss

When Meridian Mutual settles a total loss claim, it must, within 5 business days of settlement:

- Notify the state title office of the total loss determination.
- Provide the insured with a written explanation of the Actual Cash Value determination, consistent with the Total Loss Valuation Methodology, Section 2.
- If the insured retains the vehicle (electing to keep the salvage), reduce the settlement by the documented salvage value as described in Total Loss Valuation Methodology, Section 3, and ensure the resulting title carries the salvage brand.

3. Rebuilt/Reconstructed Titles

A vehicle that received a salvage title may later be issued a rebuilt (reconstructed) title after passing a state safety inspection. This has no bearing on claims

adjudication for a prior loss — it only affects the vehicle's title status and future insurability, and is noted here for completeness rather than as an adjudication rule.

4. Relationship to the Standard Adjudication Sequence

Total-loss title handling begins only after the total-loss determination itself has been made under Total Loss Valuation Methodology, Section 1. It does not change any of the five adjudication steps in the Claims Adjudication Guidelines — it is a downstream administrative consequence of Step 4 (payout computation) when that computation results in a total loss rather than a repairable claim.

5. Owner-Retained Total Losses

An insured who wishes to retain a totaled vehicle must confirm this election in writing before settlement is finalized, since the salvage-value deduction described in Section 2 depends on that election. A late election, after settlement has already been paid without a salvage deduction, requires a corrected settlement rather than a simple title amendment.